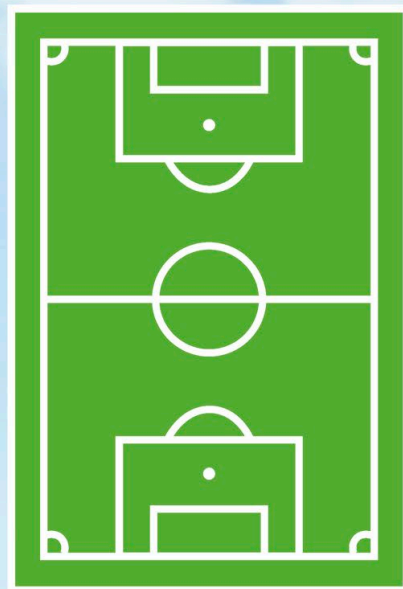




Soccer

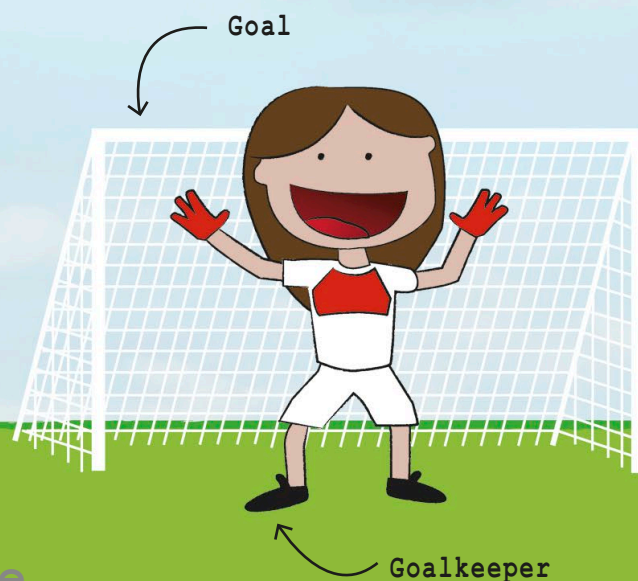
Known as the “beautiful game,” soccer, or football, is the world’s most **popular sport**. It’s played all over the globe, and its most famous tournament, the World Cup, is the planet’s biggest sporting event.



Soccer field

Simple game

The beauty of soccer is simplicity. Two teams of 11 players play on a field with a **goal** at each end. The aim is to kick a ball into the other team’s goal. The team with the most goals at the end wins.



Inventing the beautiful game

A game similar to soccer, called **Cuju**, was played in China more than 2,000 years ago, but the modern game started in England in the 19th century.

Goalkeepers defend the goals. They are the only players who are allowed to touch the ball with their hands.

